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Ohio River Trail Council

"Joining communities through fitness, recreation, heritage and transportation networks"

Ohio River Trail Wikipedia 02/14/2012

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{{Infobox organization
|name       = Ohio River Trail Council
|image      = Ohio River Trail Council logo.jpg
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|alt        = Logo of the Ohio River Trail Council
|formation  = May 26, 2009
|type       = Not-for-profit
|status     = 501(c)(3)-registered charity
|purpose    =
|headquarters = [[Monaca, Pennsylvania|Monaca]], [[Pennsylvania]]
|leader_title =
|leader_name =
|num_volunteers =
|budget     =
|website    = [http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/ Ohio River Trail Council]
}}
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The "Ohio River Trail" ("ORT") is a proposed route that would interconnect existing trails in [[Maryland]], [[Pennsylvania]], [[Ohio]] and [[West Virginia]].<ref>{{cite news |url=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/062_Biking,%20busing%20and%20buddying-up_Fewer%20commuters%20go%20it%20alone.pdf |title=Biking, busing and buddying-up: Fewer commuters go it alone |first=Michael |last=Pound |work=Beaver County Times |date=18 October 2009 |accessdate=3 May 2010}}</ref><ref>{{cite news |url=http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/10126/1055757-57.stm |first=Brian |last=David |work=Pittsburgh Post Gazette |date=6 May 2010 |accessdate=7 May 2010 |title=Council formed to plan trail link along Ohio River}}</ref> The proposal is spearheaded by the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC), a [[volunteer|volunteer-led]], [[non-profit organization]].<ref>{{cite web |url=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org |title=Welcome to the Ohio River Trail Council |publisher=Ohio River Trail Council |accessdate=18 March 2010}}</ref> The ORTC is an [[Internal Revenue Service]] registered [[501(c)(3)]] not-for-profit [[organization]] which relies on corporate, foundation, government, and private [[grants]] and [[donations]] to achieve its stated mission of creating a multi-use trail along the [[Ohio River]] and its [[tributaries]]. The Council is headquartered in [[Monaca, Pennsylvania|Monaca]], Pennsylvania.

== History ==

The Ohio River Trail Project was conceptualized on January 2, 2009, in coordination with [[Beaver County, Pennsylvania|Beaver County]] Planning Commission's Shared Greenways & [[Environmental Planning|Environmental Planner]] Doniele Andrus; the Borough of Monaca Manager Mario Leone Jr.<ref>{{cite news |url=http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/11184/1157941-57-0.stm?cmpid=localstate.xml |work=Pittsburgh Post-Gazette |title=Monaca in Beaver County becomes a model of sustainability |date=3 July 2011}}</ref> and Dr. Vincent Troia.

On May 26, 2009, the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) was incorporated by Vincent Troia and Mario Leone, for the purpose of establishing a [[trail|multi-use trail]] along the Ohio River to promote the growth in River & Trail towns of [[recreation]], [[health]], [[Wellness (alternative medicine)|wellness]], [[transportation]], [[cultural]] and [[historical]] [[amenities]], [[education]], charity, the protection and conservation of [[natural resources]] and to stimulate the local [[economy|economies]].

The Trail and its proposed connections were conceived by Dr. [[Vincent Troia]].

The Ohio River Trail Council began as a grass-roots effort to support a progressing state and national movement to develop greenways, especially since 1987 when [[Ronald Reagan|President Reagan's]] Commission on "American Outdoors" recommended establishing a national greenways network. Pennsylvania's state-wide greenways program was established by Governor [[Tom Ridge]] in 2001 to promote and support the greenway efforts occurring in all [[List of counties in Pennsylvania|sixty-seven counties]].

== Proposed trails ==

The trail is proposed to run from the [[Point of Beginning]] (mile marker zero) at the OH-PA-WV state line near the Little Beaver Creek Greenway Trail, a segment of the Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway, to the [[Beaver River Trail]], the [[Chesapeake and Ohio Canal]] Trail via the [[Montour Trail]] in [[Moon Township, Pennsylvania]], the [[Three Rivers Heritage Trail]] in [[Pittsburgh]] and the [[Great Allegheny Passage]].<ref>http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_Ohio%20River%20Trail%20Development%20in%20Allegheny%20County%202010.pdf</ref> The proposed ORT is a critical and missing link to nationally-significant trail linkages in the [[tri-state area]] and is intended to become an important segment in a "mega-trail" from the [[Great Lakes]] region, through to [[Washington, D.C.]]<ref>http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_Kasp9HkrUs</ref>



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In addition to the Tri-state [[Greenway (landscape)|Greenway]], the ORTC also supports that the Ohio River Trail serve as part of the [[U.S. Bicycle Route System]] Route 50 and the Underground Railroad, Pittsburgh spur. The Ohio River Trail corridor is part of the [[National Park Service]] [[Rivers of Steel]] [[National Heritage Area]].

The Ohio River Trail is intended to improve the quality of life of its users by providing [[Physical fitness|fitness]] and [[recreation]] opportunities. In addition, the ORT can serve as an alternative [[transportation]] [[Transport corridor|corridor]] between communities, as well as reducing vehicle [[Traffic congestion|congestion]] and [[pollution]]. Plans also exist to enable the [[disabled]] to comfortably make use of the trail.<ref>{{cite news|url=<http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/11061/1128932-455.stm> | work=Pittsburgh Post-Gazette | first=Jon | last=Schmitz | title=Advocates fret new rules for hiking, biking trails | date=2 March 2011}}</ref> The project includes the reallocation of abandoned rail corridors, bridges, [[interurban]] or trolley lines, and canal [[towpath]]s as public multi-use trails. An emphasis exists on showcasing and preserving [[historical]] and [[cultural]] sites along the trail, alongside the establishment of an Ohio River Trail [[Museum]] and endorsement of the revitalization of the surrounding area.

The Trail is composed of twenty-seven (27) [[Western Pennsylvania]] communities. There are twelve (12) North Shore communities: [[Glasgow, Pennsylvania|Glasgow]], [[Ohioville]], [[Midland, Pennsylvania|Midland]], [[Industry, Pennsylvania|Industry]], [[Vanport Township, Pennsylvania|Vanport Township]], [[Beaver, Pa|Beaver]], [[Bridgewater, Pennsylvania|Bridgewater]], [[Fallston, Pennsylvania|Fallston]], [[New Brighton, Pennsylvania|New Brighton]], [[Rochester, Pennsylvania|Rochester]], and [[Rochester Township, Pennsylvania|Rochester Township]]. There are also ten (10) South Shore communities: [[Monaca, Pennsylvania|Monaca]], [[Center Township, Beaver County, Pennsylvania|Center Township]], [[Aliquippa, Pennsylvania|Aliquippa]], [[Hopewell Township, Beaver County, Pennsylvania|Hopewell Township]], [[South Heights, Pennsylvania|South Heights]], [[Crescent Township, Pennsylvania|Crescent Township]], [[Moon Township, Pennsylvania|Moon Township]], [[Coraopolis, Pennsylvania|Coraopolis]], and [[Montour Railroad|Montour Junction]]. [[Neville Township, Allegheny County, Pennsylvania|Neville Township]] is the tenth community with the extension over the Neville Island Bridge. In addition, the North Shore Extension Communities include the boroughs of [[Ambridge, Pennsylvania|Ambridge]], [[Leetsdale, Pennsylvania|Leetsdale]], [[Edgeworth, Pennsylvania|Edgeworth]] and [[Sewickley, Pennsylvania|Sewickley]]. The Bradys Run Extension adds [[Patterson Township, Beaver County, Pennsylvania|Patterson Township]] and [[Brighton Township, Pennsylvania|Brighton Township]].

The Ohio River Trail Council has also proposed the development the Ohio River Water Trail. The Water Trail will have canoe,kayak and rowing access to the Ohio River and its tributaries. Presently the Little Beaver Creek has access at Lock 57 Park in Ohioville, the Ohio River has access at Monaca, and the Beaver River has access at Bridgewater & Rochester's Riverfront Park. The ORTC will support the design, construction and the installation of a kayak and canoe launch site in these areas with amenities including signage and a canoe/kayak storage rack.

The project is expected to bring [[economic]] boons to [[Western Pennsylvania]] through the growth of the [[construction]] and maintenance industries, in addition to [[tourism|tourism-related]] opportunities such as [[rafting]] tours, bicycle sales and rentals, restaurants, and lodging.

== Current status ==

The campaign to build the [[rail trail]] that will eventually link [[Lake Erie]] with [[Washington, D.C.]] via [[Beaver County, Pennsylvania|Beaver County]],<ref>{{cite news |url= http://www.pittsburghlive.com/x/pittsburghtrib/news/pittsburgh/s_769709.html# |title= Beaver County trail would help connect Erie to nation's capital |first=Karen |last=Kadilak |work= Pittsburgh Post Gazette |location=Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania |date=1 December 2011 |accessdate=1 December 2011}}</ref> has progressed to the point that the organizers, Vincent Troia and Mario Leone, are prepared to display their work.<ref>{{cite news |url=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/062_Plans%20coming%20together%20for%20Ohio%20River%20Trail.pdf |title=Plans coming together for Ohio River Trail |first=Michael |last=Pound |work=Beaver County Times |date=22 September 2009 |accessdate=3 May 2010}}</ref> In an interview with [[Beaver County Times]] [[journalist]] Michael Pound, regarding the status of the [[Ohio River]] Trail Project, the pair stated they have successfully solicited [[Resolution (law)|resolutions]] of support from the [[Beaver County, Pennsylvania|Beaver County]] communities,<ref>{{cite news |url=<http://www.reviewonline.com/page/content.detail/id/515711.html/> |title=County supports bike trail extension |first=Tom |last=Giambroni |work=The Review |location=East Liverpool, Ohio |date=21 June 2009 |accessdate=18 March 2010}}</ref> through which the South Shore Trail would pass, and that they will soon have similar resolutions from the [[Allegheny County, Pennsylvania|Allegheny County]] communities.

The cost of the South Shore [[feasibility study]] is estimated at \$50,000. Leone and Troia stated that the [[not-for-profit organization]] has already put together sufficient money for the match required for a grant from the [[Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources]]. The feasibility study has been awarded to Stromberg, Garrigan & Associates, and it is estimated to require six to ten months to complete.<ref>{{cite news |url=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/062_Trail_building%20effort%20picks%20up%20steam.pdf |title=Trail-building effort picks up steam |first=Michael |last=Pound |work=Beaver County Times |date=4 May 2010 |accessdate=21 April 2010}}</ref>

On January 6, 2010, the [[Ohio River]] Trail South Shore [[feasibility study]] began with a project steering committee meeting. The feasibility study for the south shore is expected to be completed in the spring of 2011 at a projected cost of \$40,000.<ref>{{cite news |url=<http://post-gazette.com/pg/10196/1072829-57.stm> |title=Ohio River Trail study nears end |work=Pittsburgh Post Gazette |first=Brian |last=David |date=15 July 2010 |accessdate=17 July 2010}}</ref><ref>{{cite news |url=<http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/10198/1073410-139.stm> |title=A lot of good news for bicyclists to cheer about |work=Pittsburgh Post Gazette |first=Larry |last=Walsh |date=17 July 2010 |accessdate=19 July 2010}}</ref>



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On June 12, 2010, the "Plant a Wish" project took place at the [[Point of Beginning]]. The project was intended to raise awareness of the Ohio River Trail effort, with participants from [[Ohio]], [[Pennsylvania]] and [[West Virginia]] writing down their wishes on pieces of paper, which were then buried beneath the site of a newly planted tree.<ref>{{cite news |url=<http://www.reviewonline.com/page/content.detail/id/527793.html> |title=Plant a Wish |work=The Review |date=10 June 2010 |accessdate=14 June 2010}}</ref><ref>{{cite news |url=<http://www.reviewonline.com/page/content.detail/id/527793.html> |title=Tri-state united for Plant a Wish |first=Katie |last=Schwendeman|work=The Review |date=13 June 2010 |accessdate=14 June 2010}}</ref> It is hoped that the Point of Beginning will also host the beginning of a bike trail that would run up the Ohio River and conclude at [[Montour Trail|Montour Creek]].<ref>{{cite news |url=<http://post-gazette.com/pg/10196/1072803-57.stm> |title=Point of Beginning may get bike trail |work=Pittsburgh Post Gazette |first=Brian |last=David |date=15 July 2010 |accessdate=17 July 2010}}</ref>

On July 28, 2010, the Council was awarded a \$10,000 grant by the [[Port of Pittsburgh Commission]]<ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/160_ORTC_Port%20of%20Pittsburgh%20Comission%20Grant%2007_06_2010.pdf</ref> on the understanding that it will be used to develop blueways and build bike and canoe racks at points in Rochester, Monaca, Bridgewater, and Ohioville.<ref>{{cite news |url=[http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_Ohio%20River%20Trail%20Council%20receives%20\\$10,000%20grant.pdf](http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_Ohio%20River%20Trail%20Council%20receives%20$10,000%20grant.pdf) |title=Ohio River Trail Council receives \$10,000 grant |first=Michael |last=Pound |work=Beaver County Times |date=28 July 2010 |accessdate=29 July 2010}}</ref><ref>{{cite news |url=<http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/10213/1076518-140.stm> |title=Plan for water trail gets funding |first=John |last=Hayes |work=Pittsburgh Post Gazette |date=1 August 2010 |accessdate=4 August 2010}}</ref><ref>{{cite news |url=http://www.pittsburghlive.com/x/pittsburghtrib/news/pittsburgh/s_693530.html |title=River users may get trails in waterways |first=Matthew |last=Sanтони |work=Pittsburgh Tribune-Review |date=5 August 2010 |accessdate=6 August 2010}}</ref>

The cost of the North Shore feasibility study is estimated at \$56,000. On October 14, 2010 the Pennsylvania Department of Natural Resources (DCNR) awarded the Ohio River Trail a \$29,000 grant for the North Shore Feasibility Study. The North Shore Feasibility Study is began in January 2011.

<ref>{{cite web |url=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_ORTC_DCNR%20North%20Shore%20Press%20Release%20October%2020,%202010.pdf |title=October 20, 2010 press release}}</ref>

On October 15, 2010 the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) and our partner the Borough of Monaca, PA along with three of its partner municipalities, Aliquippa, Coraopolis and Midland has received a grant for a \$150,000 [[United States Environmental Protection Agency]] (EPA) Brownfields Area-Wide Planning Program Grant and Assistance to advance our ongoing regional brownfields revitalization. These municipalities have joined to undertake a grass-roots effort to re-think the future of our communities as a way to overcome the loss of a major portion of our manufacturing base and the post-industrial brownfields legacy that remains from that

loss.<ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_ORTC_Monaca%20EPA%20Press%20Release%20February%2020,%202011.pdf</ref><ref>{{cite news| url=<http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/11062/1129098-57.stm> | work=Pittsburgh Post-Gazette | title=Grant to help tackle brownfields in Monaca | date=3 March 2011}}</ref><ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/062_Ohio%20River%20Trail%20group%20receives%20federal%20grant.pdf</ref><ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/062_Grant%20to%20help%20identify%20new%20use%20for%20local%20land.pdf</ref>

On October 25, 2010, the [[National Park Service]] (NPS) Rivers, Trails, and Conservation (RTCA) Program approved an application for a technical assistance grant for the Ohio River Trail Council. Over the next year, the NPS Rivers & Trails staff will assist the ORTC with the completion of a Feasibility Study and to expand public involvement in the project.<ref=<http://www.nps.gov/nrcr/programs/rtca/whatwedo/projects/PA.pdf></ref>

Efforts are underway to communicate and collaborate with other trail groups, and to establish a Tri-State Trail Alliance in order to increase visibility and success of each smaller trail component of a greater linking trail system. The National Park Service is proud to support such a capable partner and eager to help contribute to the ORT Initiative. Through the RTCA Program, the NPS helps communities and neighborhoods improve their important local resources, protect river resources, develop new trails and greenways and create and manage open

space.<ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_ORTC_NPS%20Press%20Release%20January%202018,%202011.pdf</ref>

<ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/161_ORTC_National%20Park%20Service%20RTCA%20Grant%202010.pdf</ref>

<ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_Ohio%20River%20Trail%20Council%20gets%20assistance%20from%20feds.pdf</ref>

<ref=http://www.pittsburghlive.com/x/pittsburghtrib/news/pittsburgh/s_718766.html</ref>

<ref>{{cite news| url=<http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/11020/1119249-57.stm> | work=Pittsburgh Post-Gazette | title=National Park Service to assist Ohio River trail study | date=20 January 2011}}</ref>

<ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_Ohio%20River%20Trail%20Council%20gets%20assistance%20from%20feds.pdf</ref>

<ref>{{cite news| url=<http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/11051/1126364-140.stm> | work=Pittsburgh Post-Gazette | first=Shannon M. | last=Nass | title=Ohio River Trail gets support | date=20 February 2011}}</ref>

"In September of 2010, a planning grant was awarded to the Friends of the Riverfront to begin an effort to connect the Three Rivers Heritage Trail from the City of Pittsburgh to Coraopolis. This eight mile segment will traverse through the City of Pittsburgh, McKees Rocks, Stowe Township, Moon Township, Neville Township and Coraopolis. This effort will compliment the work of the Ohio River Trail Council and Lawrence and Beaver Counties, which have completed trail feasibility work outside of Allegheny County. Once feasibility work from the City of Pittsburgh to Coraopolis is complete, we will have a good understanding of the opportunity for trail development along the Ohio River all the way to



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Ohio. In Ohio, groups are working to connect to our trail here in Pennsylvania. You will see a lot more activity along the Ohio River in 2011."
<ref=http://www.friendsoftheriverfront.org/misc_docs/Riverfront%20Report%202010%20Web.pdf></ref>

The South Shore Feasibility Study which began on Jan 6, 2010 was completed in March 2011. The resultant Ohio River South Shore Trail is approximately 15.6 miles from Monaca to the beginning of the Montour Trail.

In 2011, the first year of assistance from the NPS, the RTCA assisted with the development of the Ohio River Water Trail and the Ohio River Land Trail feasibility studies. In addition, the RTCA supported the ORTC in a multi-state effort, which included eighteen counties in three states to link a system of trails in Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. On March 29, 2011 a Tri-state Trail Alliance meeting of 80 trail advocates and on October 13, 2011 a regional trails meeting hosted by the Power of 32 occurred to support the vision of linking a system of trails in the tri-state area. On October 25, 2010, the National Park Service (NPS) Rivers, Trails, and Conservation (RTCA) Program awarded a second year of technical assistance to the Ohio River Trail Council. <ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/161_ORTC_National%20Park%20Service%20RTCA%20Award%202011.pdf></ref> In 2012, the NPS Rivers & Trails staff will focus on identifying an on-the-ground section of the Ohio River Land/Water Trail to develop and continue the oversight for the Tri-State Trail Initiative.

On April 6, 2011 the ORTC received a second grant from the Port of Pittsburgh Commission to establish a small [[watercraft]] [[launch (boat)|launch]] in [[Beaver Falls, Pennsylvania]]. <ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/160_ORTC_Port%20of%20Pittsburgh%20Commission%20Grant%2004_06_2011.pdf></ref>

On October 26, 2011 the National Park Service approved the Ohio River Trail Council's application for a second year of technical assistance from the Rivers, Trails and Conservation Assistance Program. In the first year of assistance, RTCA assisted the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) with the development of the Ohio River Water Trail and the Ohio River Land Trail Feasibility Studies. In addition, the RTCA helped coordinate the March 29, 2011 Tri-state Trail Alliance meeting of about 80 trail advocates, and the October 13, 2011 regional trails meeting hosted by the Power of 32, to support the vision of linking a system of trails in Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. In 2012, the NPS Rivers & Trails staff will focus on identifying an on-the-ground section of the Ohio River Land/Water Trail to develop, and continue the oversight for the Tri-State Trail Initiative, a multi-state effort which includes eighteen counties in three states. The Pennsylvania counties include Beaver, Crawford, Erie, Greene, Lawrence, Mercer and Washington. <ref=http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/124_Ohio%20River%20Trail%20receives%20second%20award%20from%20the%20National%20Park%20Service.pdf></ref><ref>{{cite news| url=<http://www.post-gazette.com/pg/12001/1200291-140.stm>| work=Pittsburgh Post-Gazette | first=Shannon M. | last=Nass | title=Agencies partner on trail expansion | date=1 January 2012}}</ref> The Ohio Counties include Ashtabula, Belmont, Columbiana, Jefferson, Mahoning, Monroe and Trumbull. The West Virginia counties include Brooke, Hancock, Marshall and Ohio.

==See also==

- *[[Abandoned Pennsylvania Turnpike]]
- *[[Beaver River Trail]]
- *[[East Coast Greenway]]
- *[[Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources|DCNR]]
- *[[Great Allegheny Passage]]
- *[[Lower Trail, Pennsylvania]]
- *[[Montour Trail]]
- *[[North Country Trail]]
- *[[Ohio to Erie Trail]]
- *[[Panhandle Trail]]
- *[[Rails-to-Trails Conservancy]]
- *[[Rails with trails]]
- *[[Three Rivers Heritage Trail]]
- *[[Youghiogheny River Trail]]

==References==

{{Reflist}}

==External links==

- *<http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/> Official Site]
- *http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/attachments/144_epa_awp_monaca_pa.pdf Pilot Project Fact Sheet]
- *<http://www.americantrails.org/resources/railtrails/index.html> American Trails]
- *ftp://ftp.dot.state.pa.us/public/pdf/bikes/state_mapA.pdf BicyclePa - Route A]
- *<http://www.bicycletrail.com/2008/gwt-home.htm> Little Beaver Creek Greenway Trail]
- *<http://metroparks.co.trumbull.oh.us/DocLibrary/GOLRGbrochureInside2008.pdf> Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway]
- *<http://www.railserve.com/Rails-to-Trails/> Rail Serve]



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*[<http://www.railtrails.org> Rails-to-Trails Conservancy]
*[<http://www.trailsfromrails.com> Trails from Rails]
*[<http://www.railstotrails.us> United States Rails To Trails]
*[<http://www.gis.dcnr.state.pa.us/railtrails/oneTrail.aspx?name=Stavich+Bike+Trail> Stavich Bike Trail]
*[<http://www.northcountrytrail.org/> North County Trail]

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[[Category:501(c)(3) nonprofit organizations]]

Sincerely,

Dr. Vincent Troia

Dr. Vincent Troia
Chief Executive Chairmen & CEO
02/14/2012